

STRUCTURE: the file tree

ar013 · 7 July 2026

A demolab repo has a place for everything, and the layout is the same in every repo. Once you know the four content directories, the engine, and the reconciled root files, you can find anything by name. A fresh clone ships *engine-only* (just `demolab-engine/` and the root files) and task scaffold lays down the empty content tree below.

```
demolab/
├─ tools/           the science - one directory per tool (tool.py + tests)
├─ experiments/     the runners - one expNNN.py per experiment
├─ writings/        the writeups - one .typ per entry, by id
├─ artifacts/       the committed record of every run
│   ├─ data/<id>/    figures + numbers.json - the neutral record
│   ├─ pdfs/         compiled PDFs (shareable)
│   └─ site/         the built web site - GITIGNORED
├─ demolab.yaml     optional branding + collections config
├─ HOUSESTYLE.local.md optional house-style overrides
├─ demolab-engine/   the engine - the BLACK BOX
├─ AGENTS.md · README.md · Taskfile.yml · pyproject.toml
└─ temp/           short-lived run scratch - GITIGNORED
```

The four content directories

These are yours. `tools/` holds the science, one directory per tool, each with its CLI in `tool.py` and a test beside it. `experiments/` holds the runners: one `expNNN.py` per experiment, which invokes a tool, renders figures, and stages its output. `writings/` holds the writeups, one `.typ` file per entry: an `expNNN.typ` reads an experiment's run, an `arNNN.typ` is a prose-only article, and an `arNNN.slide.typ` compiles to a standalone slide deck. `artifacts/` is the committed record: `data/<id>/` keeps each run's figures and `numbers.json`, and `pdfs/` keeps the shareable PDFs. Both of those are in git; `artifacts/site/` and `temp/` are gitignored because the build regenerates them.

What ties an experiment together is its *id*, not a folder. The same `exp000` threads through all three: `experiments/exp000.py` runs it, `artifacts/data/exp000/` records it, `writings/exp000.typ` writes it up.

The engine and the root files

`demolab-engine/` is the *black box*. It holds the Typst publisher, the scaffold templates, the agent runbooks, and the guides, and you never hand-edit it. When you update demolab, the whole engine is swapped wholesale. Everything you own lives *outside* it.

Two optional files sit at the root: `demolab.yaml` for branding and collections, and `HOUSESTYLE.local.md` for house-style overrides. The remaining root files, `AGENTS.md`, `README.md`, `Taskfile.yml`, `pyproject.toml`, and the CI workflow, are framework files that are reconciled by diff on update rather than swapped, so your local edits survive.

Learning it interactively

Type **STRUCTURE** in capitals and the coding agent will walk you through this tree, path by path, in your own repo.

The full reference lives in `STRUCTURE.md`.